

Wii May Overcome

Nintendo's much-awaited Wii finally launched mid-November, and Nintendo execs confidently state that Wiis will be floating into the US markets in generous numbers, so Christmas shoppers who missed out on the scarce PS3s can go the Wii way.



Big Brother Is Stopping Your Fights

"Aggression detectors" in UK public places will now alert the cops of any disturbing activity (like a brawl) automatically, by analysing surrounding sounds for anything that resembles aggressive tones. The infrastructure? Just a CCTV camera with a microphone!



Enter

Archana Puran Singh
Actress

Archana Puran Singh is a noted actress with over 40 films; her latest being *Krrish*, *The Gold Bracelet*, and *Mera Dil Leke Dekho*. She has worked in several TV serials and is also a well-known anchor.

Technology to you is....

A boon and also a pain in the a**! Technology should be simple to use. It should be your slave and not the other way round!

What gadgets do you use?

A mobile, a DVD player, a handycam—though I've replaced it with a digital camera—and a computer.

What's your dream gadget?

Before the start of my career, I was a paying guest. At that time, my roommates and I wished we had a machine that would magically cook whatever we wished for. Now I value time a lot, and wish there were a teleporting machine that could beam my family and me from one place to another.

Any instance where tech has really helped you?

Six months ago, when there was heavy rain in Mumbai, my car was stuck in three feet of water—and began to float! Thanks to my mobile, I could inform my husband, and he told me what I should do. Also, during the Mumbai bomb blasts when calls were not going through, messaging was still possible, and I could locate my husband and kids.

TRUE COLOURS

MS All For Linux... Sort Of

Early November, we choked on our breakfasts with the news that Microsoft and Novell would be partnering on a Linux project—the company has stated that it will henceforth promote SuSE Linux Enterprise to those companies who want to work with both Windows and Linux at the same time.

Considering that the two companies have been as friendly in the past as fire and water, the move sent ripples through the open source community, sparking conspiracy theories ranging from the crazy-snake-man type to the scarily plausible. However, the move does make good business sense for both parties—Microsoft gets itself a Guiding Light™ in the Linux domain (it obviously sees profits in this move), and Novell gets the one-up over arch-rival Red Hat. And yet, something didn't seem right.

As if on cue, Microsoft CEO Steve Ballmer, in the Q&A session following his speech at the Professional Association for SQL Server (PASS) conference in Seattle,

came up with some interesting comments. The first of these: "Because of the way the GPL works, and because open source Linux does not come from a company—Linux comes from the community—the fact that that

rumours you've been hearing about stands softening towards Linux and open source have been eyewash. The essence of the statement is that if you're using Linux, you're stealing from Microsoft, unless you give them money for it.

However, there is some friendliness—"... we want SuSE Linux to have the highest percent share of that, because only a customer who has SuSE Linux actually has paid properly for the use of intellectual property from Microsoft." And "We are willing to do the same deal with Red Hat and other Linux distributors; it's not an exclusive thing".

Raging tempers in the open source community aside, there are more sinister implications to this than it might seem. Tech companies

have been suing each other for Intellectual Property infringements as a seeming side business, and with this attitude, every single Linux user might end up a possible target for Microsoft's crack team of lawyers. Scary, isn't it? Interestingly, though, Ballmer didn't state any specifics as to what "patented intellectual property" Linux has stolen from them.

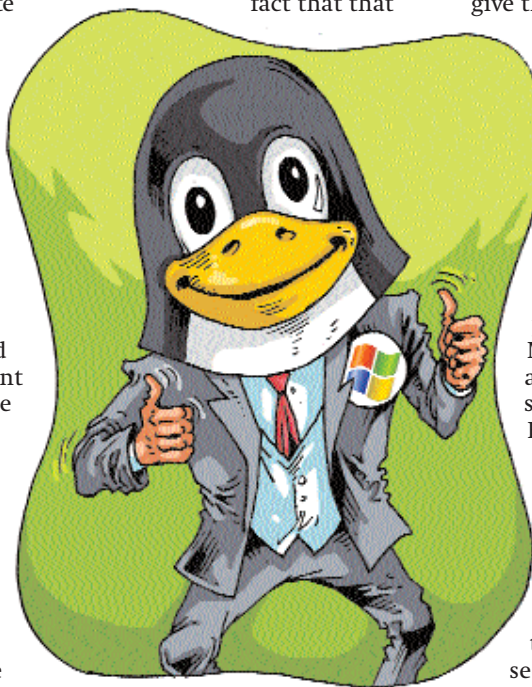


Illustration Harsho Mohan Chatteraj

product uses our *patented intellectual property* is a problem for our shareholders. We spend \$7 billion a year on R&D, *our shareholders expect us to protect or license or get economic benefit from our patented innovations.*" (We've added the italics for emphasis). The paranoia we were talking about last month seems not to have been unfounded—all those

